

TRIBAL ANTHROPOLOGY - COMPREHENSIVE NOTES

Part 2: Problems of Tribal Communities (Unit 6.2)

Paper 2 | Sarrthi IAS (Nataraj Sir) | Thor x Team Avengers

SOCIO-ECONOMIC MARGINALISATION FRAMEWORK

Causes of Marginalisation (Mind Map)

Category	Details
Exploitation	By missionaries, moneylenders, NGOs, govt officials, contractors
Forest Policies	Restrictive forest laws (Indian Forest Act 1927)
Poor Implementation	Plans, policies, laws fail to reach tribals
Displacement	Mining, dams, industrial projects
Primitive Economy	Low-productivity agricultural techniques
Social Spending	Extravagant expenses in marriage, fairs, festivals
Geographical Isolation	Cut off from mainstream Indian society

Key Problems: Land alienation, indebtedness, poverty, low literacy, unemployment, health and nutrition, alcohol addiction, ethnic conflicts, Naxalism, lack of inclusive development.

PROBLEM 1: LAND ALIENATION (6.2.1)

Definition: The process by which tribals lose ownership or access to their traditional land.

Why Land Matters to Tribals

Land is NOT merely economic - it is the basis of **social identity, cultural continuity, and ecological survival**.

Key Scholar Quotes

Scholar	Quote/Contribution
L.P. Vidyarthi	"Land alienation is the ROOT CAUSE of all forms of tribal unrest and discontent"
Dhebar Commission	"Loss of land = loss of livelihood, dignity, and identity"

Scholar	Quote/Contribution
Xaxa (2001)	In Koraput (Odisha), tribal landholdings fell by over 50% between 1970-1990

9 Major Causes of Land Alienation

- 1. Chronic Shortage of Cash:** Low income forces borrowing at exploitative terms. Example: Korwa Tribe (MP) exploited by moneylenders.
- 2. Inadequate Agricultural Yield:** Traditional tools, no irrigation, small landholdings, infertile soils.
- 3. Chronic Indebtedness:** Moneylenders exploit illiterate tribals, take land as mortgage. Example: Tharu and Bhoksa (UP) - post-Partition Punjab refugees exploited local tribals through fraudulent contracts.
- 4. Ill Experience with State Credit:** Complex formalities and delays push tribals back to informal lenders.
- 5. Mining and Industrial Projects:**
 - 261 Baiga families displaced by Vedanta's BALCO bauxite mining (Chhattisgarh)
 - Niyamgiri Hills (Odisha): Dongria Kondhs resisted Vedanta's mining
 - Karanpura Coalfield: 83 coal blocks, 203 villages, 75,000+ ha land acquired in Jharkhand. Activist Mithilesh Dangi (Azadi Bachao Andolan) warns entire Barkagaon block will vanish
- 6. Infrastructure Projects (Dams):**
 - Narmada Valley Project: 30 major + 135 medium + 3000 small dams. 200,000 people displaced, majority Adivasis
 - Narmada Bachao Andolan (1985 onwards): Mass protests against displacement

7. National Parks, Tiger Reserves:

Case	Detail
Kanha Tiger Reserve (2014)	450 Baiga and Gond families evicted
Kuno National Park	Asmita Kabra (2009): 80% of displaced Saharias below poverty line
Orang National Park, Assam (2017)	1,000 Bodo, Rabha, Mishing people evicted
Soliga tribes (BRT Hills)	ALLOWED to stay - tiger population INCREASED (co-existence works!)

8. Forest Policies: Indian Forest Act 1927 removed community ownership, criminalised traditional livelihoods.

9. Lack of Law Implementation: LARR Act 2013 poorly implemented.

Other Modes of Alienation

- Using court machinery - moneylenders drag tribals to court; legal ignorance ensures land loss
- Temptation of immediate gains - tribals lured into selling for short-term cash
- Voluntary surrender - engineered by landlords exploiting illiteracy

5 Consequences of Land Alienation

#	Consequence	Detail/Scholar
1	Loss of livelihood	Dispossession from forest and cultivable land
2	Erosion of traditional institutions	Khuntkatti (Mundas), Bhuinhari (Oraons) systems collapse
3	Migration and urban drift	Seasonal migration to Raipur, Ranchi, brick kilns
4	Social stratification	B.K. Roy Burman: Class differentiation within the tribe
5	Conflict and unrest	Walter Fernandes: Displacement leads to development-induced impoverishment

Impact on Tribal Women

- Women lose access to forest produce, firewood, fodder, shifting cultivation plots
- Baiga and Gond women in MP: once managed Bewar fields, now depend on daily wages
- Displacement negotiations only with male heads - women get NO ownership or compensation
- Polavaram Dam (AP): Female-headed households least compensated, most food insecure

Protective Legislations

Law	Key Provision
Chotanagpur Tenancy Act (1908)	Restricts transfer of tribal land to non-tribals in Jharkhand
Santhal Pargana Tenancy Act (1949)	Prohibits land transfer even for public purposes
Forest Rights Act (FRA), 2006	Recognises individual and community rights to land/forest
LARR Act, 2013	Fair compensation and rehabilitation

Way Forward: Effective enforcement, participatory governance, community land rights under FRA, tribal consent + compensation + cultural continuity.

PROBLEM 2: POVERTY (6.2.2)

Definition: Multi-dimensional and structural problem rooted in historical marginalisation, resource deprivation, and exclusion from development.

Key Statistics

Indicator	Value
STs below poverty line (Rural, 2004-05)	62.3%
STs below poverty line (Rural, 2011-12)	45.3% (declined but still POOREST group)
STs below poverty line (Urban, 2011-12)	24.1%

SCHOLAR - D.N. Majumdar: "Tribal poverty is not merely economic but an outcome of DISLOCATION from the ecological niche and exploitation by dominant society."

B.D. Sharma's FIVE LEVELS OF DEPRIVATION

Level	Description	Example
1. Non-recognition of Rights	Denied access to forest, land, water	Loss of ancestral land during Narmada Dam without consent
2. Alienation from Production	Pushed into bonded/daily wage labour	Bonded labour in central India
3. Denial of Due Wages	Unfair/lower wages	Adivasi tea workers in Assam earn less than non-tribals
4. Bartering of Liberty	Trafficking and forced prostitution	Tribal women/girls in Jharkhand, Odisha, CG
5. Psychological Acceptance	Loss of self-respect, fatalism	Internalised poverty from continuous exploitation

Additional Causes

Cause	Detail
Moneylenders	Dependence on private lenders; land mortgaged and lost
Developmental Displacement	Dams, mining displace lakhs
Systemic Barriers	Discrimination, remoteness, lack of political voice
Education/Healthcare Gaps	NFHS-5: high malnutrition; education gaps restrict jobs
Weak Welfare Implementation	IRDP, MGNREGA, PDS fail to reach remote areas

Case Studies

- **Tharu & Bhoksa (UP):** Exploited by post-Partition refugee moneylenders
- **Baiga & Gond (MP):** Kanha Tiger Reserve (2014) evictions deepened poverty
- **Saharias (MP) - SCHOLAR Asmita Kabra (2009):** Post-displacement poverty after Kuno relocation due to loss of MFP access

5 Consequences

- Chronic indebtedness (moneylenders exploit through unfair interest)
- Dehumanising conditions: 54% lack improved sanitation; 47% lack safe drinking water (NFHS-5)
- Health: Infant mortality 40% higher than national average (MoTA, 2021)
- Loss of autonomy: Dependence on MGNREGA/PDS weakens traditional systems
- Inter-generational deprivation: **L.P. Vidyarthi** noted vicious cycle in Ranchi tribal studies

Impact on Tribal Women

- Average daily work exceeds 12 hours (ICSSR study on Santhal women)
- Women eat last and least - over 60% anaemia among tribal females (NFHS-5)

Schemes and Interventions

Scheme	Key Detail
IRDP	Assisted 42% tribal families up to 8th Plan

Scheme	Key Detail
Tribal Sub-Plan (1974-75)	Plan funds proportional to tribal population
FRA, 2006	Restores individual/community forest rights
PESA Act, 1996	Self-governance through Gram Sabhas
PM-JANMAN (2024)	Focuses on PVTGs
EMRS	Quality education in tribal areas
Van Dhan Yojana	Value addition of forest produce

B.D. Sharma Quote: "The tribal world is being impoverished in the name of development." Real change requires inclusive, rights-based, culturally sensitive governance.

PROBLEM 3: INDEBTEDNESS (6.2.3)

Context: Traditional tribal societies were based on subsistence economies and reciprocity. Contact with money economy introduced cash dependency, credit, and exploitation.

SCHOLAR - Christoph von Furer-Haimendorf: The shift from barter to monetised economy EXPOSED tribals to exploitation by moneylenders, contractors, traders.

SCHOLAR - Ranganathan: About 36% of ST farmer households are indebted, mostly to non-institutional sources.

Indebtedness is widespread EXCEPT in a few North-Eastern areas that were historically protected.

5 Causes of Indebtedness

#	Cause	Detail
1	Loss of Forest Rights	Indian Forest Act 1927 displaced tribals. Tripathi: Tribes once shared harmonious symbiotic relationship with forests
2	Poor Cultivation Methods	Primitive tools, low productivity, no irrigation, no surplus
3	Ignorance/Market Exploitation	Illiteracy + unfamiliarity with commerce = prey to moneylenders
4	Extravagant Ceremonial Spending	Lavish marriage and festival celebrations require borrowing
5	Role of Moneylenders	Formal credit fails; moneylender offers immediate cash but at exorbitant interest

5 Consequences of Indebtedness

1. Loss of Freedom / Bonded Labour:

- CASE STUDY - Sahariya tribe (Baran, Rajasthan): Work as bonded labourers under the HALI SYSTEM despite Bonded Labour Abolition Act, 1976

2. Alienation of Land: Land seized by creditors leading to chronic landlessness.

3. Sale of Girls / Human Trafficking:

- CASE STUDY - Bedia community: Women pushed into prostitution as debt-repayment practice

4. Health Impacts:

- SCHOLAR - V.G. Rao: Study in Jabalpur (MP) found 36.5% prevalence of STDs among tribal villagers

5. Bonded Labour and Hereditary Debt:

- CASE STUDY - Juang PVTGs (Odisha): GOTI system binds families into labour for GENERATIONS despite Orissa Debt Bondage Abolition Act, 1948
- SCHOLAR - Anumeha Yadav: Reports practice continues despite laws

Impact on Tribal Women

- Women pushed into bonded labour or sexual exploitation
- Ho and Munda women (Jharkhand/Odisha) employed as domestic servants through exploitative networks
- Indebtedness breaks kinship support, making women vulnerable to trafficking

Legislations

Law/Initiative	Key Feature
AP Scheduled Areas Moneylenders Regulation, 1963	Regulates credit in tribal areas
Fifth Schedule of Constitution	States can regulate moneylending in Scheduled Areas
MP (2019): All unlicensed moneylender loans waived	Anusuchit Jan Jaati Sahukar Viniyam, 1972
NSTFDC	Concessional loans for income generation
AMSY	Loans up to 90% for projects up to Rs 2 lakh at 4% interest for tribal women
MCF (Micro Credit for SHGs)	Up to Rs 50,000 per member; Rs 5 lakh per SHG

Analysis: Despite laws, implementation remains weak. Indebtedness is BOTH a cause and consequence of underdevelopment. Need: secure land rights, community banking, financial literacy education.

PROBLEM 4: TRIBAL EDUCATION (6.2.4)

Census 2011: ST literacy = 59% vs. 73% national average (14-point gap).

SCHOLAR - Verrier Elwin: "Education must be OF THE FOREST and not AGAINST the forest, respecting their ecology and culture."

Key Statistics

Indicator	Value
ST Literacy (2001)	47.1%
ST Literacy (2011)	59%
ST Male Literacy	68.5%
ST Female Literacy	Below 50%

Indicator	Value
Highest ST Literacy	Mizoram (91.6%)
Lowest ST Literacy	Andhra Pradesh (49.2%)

Constitutional Provisions

Article	Provision
Article 46	Promote educational/economic interests of SCs, STs
Article 29(1)	Right to conserve language, script, culture
Article 15(4)	Special provisions for educational advancement of SCs/STs
Article 275(1)	Grants-in-aid for tribal welfare including education
Article 350A	Mother tongue instruction at primary stage for linguistic minorities

6 Causes of Educational Backwardness

- Poor Socio-Economic Conditions:** Education seen as luxury; children work; girls suffer most
- Lack of Infrastructure:** Few schools, far away, no electricity/sanitation/teachers
- Language Barrier:** Teaching in regional/national language, NOT tribal mother tongue = high dropouts. Article 350A seldom implemented
- Teacher Challenges:** Few trained teachers willing to serve in remote areas; cultural insensitivity
- Gender Disparity:** ST female literacy lags by nearly 20%; early marriage, no girls' hostels
- Cultural Disconnect:** Schools alienate children from traditional occupations and values

5 Consequences

#	Consequence	Detail/Scholar
1	Low literacy and dropouts	Linguistic gaps and poor infrastructure
2	Limited employability	Lack of English/technical skills keeps tribals in low-paid jobs
3	Cultural alienation	Gonds in MP find Hindi-medium education difficult
4	Gender disparity	Xaxa Committee (2014): Early marriage + household chores reduce girls' schooling
5	Leadership deficit	S.C. Dube (1955): Educated intermediaries form tribal elite serving SELF-interest

Impact on Tribal Women

- Male literacy 68.5% vs Female less than 50%

- Girls drop out due to distance, safety, early marriage
- Example: AP's PVTGs (Chenchu, Konda Reddi) - girls leave after Class V due to no female teachers/hostels

Government Schemes

Scheme	Key Feature
EMRS	Quality residential schools for STs (like Navodaya)
Ashram Schools	Residential schools in remote tribal areas
Pre/Post-Matric Scholarships	Financial aid for ST students
NEP 2020	Bilingual education; local knowledge systems
Adivasi Mahila Shikshan Kendra	Literacy centres for tribal women

Way Forward (6 Suggestions)

- 1. Infrastructure:** Expand EMRS; recruit local teachers; bilingual systems (TSR Subramanian Committee + NEP 2020)
- 2. Teacher Training:** Cultural awareness programmes; Tribal History Exhibitions in schools
- 3. Student Safety:** Protect from abuse in hostels (cases: Muzaffarpur; Maharashtra 29 tribal girls, 2011-16)
- 4. Girls' Education:** Build girls' schools/hostels; provide bicycles (Bihar model); menstrual hygiene scheme
- 5. Community Mobilisation:** Awareness camps, street plays, puppet shows
- 6. Monitoring:** Periodic reviews by District Collectors/Tribal Welfare Officers

Elwin Quote: "Let us teach the tribe not to DESPISE his culture, but to ENRICH it through knowledge."

PROBLEM 5: UNEMPLOYMENT AND UNDEREMPLOYMENT (6.2.5)

Nearly 75% of tribals engaged in agriculture (mostly subsistence-based).

SCHOLAR - Richard Mahapatra: "Tribals are quitting farming fast, and every second household now survives on manual labour in an informal economy."

Occupational Profile

Category	Examples
Agriculture (75%)	Most tribals
Pastoral	Todas, Bhotias, Gaddis, Bakarwals
Artisans	Asur, Agaria
Foragers	Chenchu, Paniya, Onga
Industrial/Migrant	Construction, domestic, mining

Statistics (NSSO, 2011-12)

Category	Male	Female
Urban ST Unemployment	3.4%	4.8%
Rural ST Unemployment	1.3%	1.1%
Rural Self-employed	56.4%	-

Category	Male	Female
Rural Casual Labour	38.8%	-
Rural Regular/Salaried	4.8% only	-

8 Causes

- 1. Loss of Traditional Livelihood:** Forest laws + industrial expansion
- 2. Displacement and Migration:** Forced migration to cities as contract labourers
- 3. Educational Deprivation:** Lack of modern marketable skills
- 4. Infrastructural Deficit:** Poor roads, electricity, internet in tribal regions
- 5. Discrimination:** Stereotypes lead to wage discrimination, fewer opportunities
- 6. Agricultural Seasonality:** Rain-fed agriculture = seasonal unemployment
- 7. Vacant Reserved Posts:** 112th Parliamentary Standing Committee (2023): 1,199 of 3,097 ST-reserved posts in 45 central universities REMAIN VACANT. **Saiyed Zegham Muntaza:** "These figures betray extreme disregard of reservation norms"
- 8. Frustration and Extremism:** Lack of opportunity leads youth to extremist movements

5 Consequences

#	Consequence	Scholar/Data
1	Seasonal underemployment	N.C. Saxena: Agriculture/forest work limited to 4-5 months/year
2	Distress migration	Jharkhand/Odisha to brick kilns in AP, factories in Surat/Mumbai
3	Skill mismatch	Less than 2% of tribal youth formally trained (2018)
4	Rise in bonded labour	MP and Rajasthan (ILO, 2016)
5	Psychological stress	Bhatia: Bastar studies link unemployment with Naxal recruitment

Impact on Tribal Women

- In Bastar: over 70% of employed tribal women = seasonal agricultural labourers under MGNREGA, earning less than men
- Forest/agriculture decline forces migration as domestic workers, brick kiln labourers
- Ranchi and Sundargarh: Rising female migration to Delhi/Mumbai = loss of community support

Government Measures

Scheme	Detail
MGNREGA	ST participation: 36% first year, now 17-20%; tribals = 20% of total workers (2x their population share)
NSTFDC	Concessional loans and entrepreneurship promotion
VTCs	Skills in handicrafts, tailoring, carpentry
Career Aspirations Scheme (2018-19)	Counselling, scholarships, placement for ST students

Scheme	Detail
India's First Tribal Employment Exchange	Trivandrum, 2018 - links tribal youth with jobs

Way Forward: Tribal Skill Development Centres; forest-based industries; strengthen MGNREGA; fill ST reserved posts backlog; tribal start-ups under Start-Up India; workplace diversity campaigns.

B.D. Sharma Quote: "Tribals are not poor by culture, but made poor by circumstance. True empowerment = dignified, skill-based employment valuing both economic and cultural capital."

PROBLEM 6: HEALTH AND NUTRITION (6.2.6)

STs = 8.6% of population but health indicators 10-25% lower than non-tribals.

SCHOLAR - Abhay Bang Committee (2018): "Tribal India faces a TRIPLE BURDEN of communicable diseases, NCDs, and mental health problems."

Key Health Statistics

Indicator	Tribal	General
Life Expectancy	63.9 years	67 years
IMR (2019-21)	41.6%	-
Under-5 Stunting	44%	38%
Underweight Children	45%	36%
Wasting	27%	21%
Adolescent Girls BMI less than 18.5	~50%	-

Disease Burden

Disease	Tribal Impact
Malaria	30% of all cases, 60% of P. falciparum cases, 50% of malaria deaths
TB	703 per 100,000 vs 256 nationally (ICMR, 2021)
NCDs	66% of tribal deaths due to NCDs (ICMR)

Triple Burden of Diseases

Category	Key Diseases
Communicable	Malaria, TB, leprosy, diarrhoea, respiratory infections
Non-Communicable	Diabetes, hypertension, cancer, chronic respiratory
Mental Health	Displacement stress, alcoholism, rising suicide

6 Major Causes

1. **Lack of Awareness:** Illness attributed to supernatural causes; reliance on ojhas, baigas, deotas
2. **Unhygienic Practices:** Open defecation, unclean childbirth, unsafe water
3. **Poor Infrastructure:** 27-40% shortfall in PHCs/Sub-centres/CHCs; 33% shortage of PHC doctors
4. **Financial Constraints:** TSP allocations often diverted
5. **Lack of Micro-Level Data:** Health planning ignores tribe-specific issues (sickle-cell anaemia, goitre)
6. **Malnutrition:** Poverty + loss of forest food = protein and micronutrient deficiency

MAJOR CASE STUDY: Keonjhar District, Odisha

"Paradox of Prosperity Without Well-Being"

- One of India's richest mineral belts - 26% of country's iron ore reserves
- Revenue through DMF and OMBADC exceeding Rs 15,000 crore
- DESPITE financial wealth: Worst-performing in child and maternal health
- NFHS-5: 74.7% of pregnant women are anaemic (state average 61.8%)
- Highest number of stunted, wasted, underweight children in Odisha
- Remote villages like Emiri inaccessible by ambulance - women travel 20+ km for delivery
- **Significance:** Shows how extractive wealth does NOT translate to tribal well-being

Impact on Tribal Women

- Maternal mortality: 167 per lakh live births (higher than national average)
- Dahanu (Maharashtra): 1 in 3 pregnancies is anaemic or underweight
- Cultural barriers keep women from antenatal care
- Santhal and Bhil women: Home births by untrained midwives = infection, complications

CASE STUDY: Gadchiroli Model (Maharashtra)

Dr. Abhay and Rani Bang's SEARCH Initiative:

- Successfully reduced neonatal mortality by training village health workers
- Home-based newborn care model
- Shows power of community participation, local training, traditional integration

Government Initiatives

Initiative	Detail
NHM	Tribal sub-plans + ASHA workers for last-mile delivery
Abhay Bang Committee (2018)	Comprehensive roadmap for tribal health
SWASTHYA Portal	Digital repository for tribal health data
Aashwasan Campaign (2022)	TB awareness in 177 tribal districts - 10 million people
Malaria Elimination (2030)	Focus on tribal districts
ICDS	Supplementary nutrition for children/lactating mothers
Poshan Abhiyaan	Reduction of stunting, underweight, anaemia
ASHAs from tribal communities	Increase trust and continuity of care

Way Forward

1. **Integrate Traditional + Modern Medicine:** AYUSH + Allopathy; recognise traditional healers (SCHOLAR - P.C. Joshi: Integration of ethnomedicine with PHCs could improve outcomes)
2. **Health Literacy:** Folk media, street plays, storytelling in tribal languages
3. **Infrastructure:** Fill doctor vacancies; hostels for expectant mothers; improve ambulance access

4. **Nutrition:** Locally grown food through PDS; restore forest rights for traditional food access
5. **Policy:** Create National Tribal Health Mission (NTHM) with state-level monitoring

Bang Committee (2019): "Tribal health is a test of India's commitment to equity."

MASTER SCHOLAR TABLE - ALL TOPICS

Scholar	Key Contribution/Quote
Marshall Sahlins	"Original Affluent Society" - hunter-gatherers
Verrier Elwin	"Education of the forest, not against the forest"; "Enrich, not despise culture"
L.P. Vidyarthi	Land alienation = root of all tribal unrest; vicious cycle of poverty (Ranchi); Nature-Man-Spirit Complex (1963)
B.D. Sharma	5 levels of deprivation; "impoverished in name of development"; "poor by circumstance not culture"
D.N. Majumdar	Tribal poverty = dislocation from ecological niche
Dhebar Commission	Loss of land = loss of livelihood, dignity, identity
N.K. Bose	Santhal agriculture bridges subsistence and market
B.K. Roy Burman	Class differentiation within tribe after land alienation
Walter Fernandes	Displacement = development-induced impoverishment
S.C. Dube (1955)	Educated intermediaries form tribal elite serving self-interest
Xaxa Committee (2014)	Early marriage and household chores reduce girls' schooling
Christoph von Furer-Haimendorf	Barter-to-money shift exposed tribals to exploitation
Ranganathan	36% of ST farmer households indebted
Tripathi	Tribes had harmonious symbiotic relationship with forests
V.G. Rao	36.5% STD prevalence among tribal villagers (Jabalpur)
Anumeha Yadav	Goti system of bonded labour persists in Odisha despite laws
Richard Mahapatra	"Tribals quitting farming fast; every 2nd household on manual labour"
N.C. Saxena	Agriculture/forest work = 4-5 months/year only
Bhatia	Bastar: unemployment linked to Naxal recruitment
Saiyed Z. Muntaza	Vacant ST posts = "extreme disregard of reservation norms"
Abhay Bang Committee (2018)	Triple burden of diseases; tribal health = test of equity
P.C. Joshi	Integrate ethnomedicine with PHCs
Asmita Kabra (2009)	80% displaced Saharias below poverty line
Marija Gimbutas	Kurgan Hypothesis - PIE homeland
Robert Caldwell (1856)	Comparative Grammar of Dravidian Languages
Krishnamurti (2003)	Dravidian = 4,000+ years old
Morris Swadesh	Glottochronology

Scholar	Key Contribution/Quote
Abbi (2017)	Deep antiquity of tribal linguistic heritage

IMPORTANT GOVERNMENT SCHEMES - MASTER TABLE

Scheme	Year	Purpose
Chotanagpur Tenancy Act	1908	Restricts tribal land transfer in Jharkhand
Indian Forest Act	1927	Removed community ownership (NEGATIVE impact)
Santhal Pargana Tenancy Act	1949	Prohibits land transfer even for public purposes
ICDS	1975	Supplementary nutrition
Tribal Sub-Plan (TSP)	1974-75	Plan funds proportional to tribal population
Bonded Labour Abolition Act	1976	Abolishes bonded labour (still violated)
TRIFED	1987	Tribal Cooperative Marketing
PESA Act	1996	Self-governance via Gram Sabhas
MGNREGA	2005	20% workers are tribals
NHM	2005	ASHA workers; tribal sub-plans
FRA	2006	Individual and community forest rights
LARR Act	2013	Fair compensation and rehabilitation
Poshan Abhiyaan	2018	Reduce stunting, underweight, anaemia
NEP	2020	Bilingual education; local knowledge
Aashwasan Campaign	2022	TB awareness in 177 tribal districts
PM-JANMAN	2024	Focuses on PVTGs
Van Dhan Yojana	Ongoing	Value addition of MFP
EMRS	Ongoing	Quality education for tribal students
NSTFDC	Ongoing	Concessional loans for STs
AMSY	Ongoing	4% interest loans for tribal women

PROBABLE UPSC QUESTIONS

1. Economic life of Indian tribes - hunting-gathering, pastoralism, shifting cultivation with ethnographic examples (20 marks)
2. Nilgiri inter-tribal interdependence model - significance and impact of modernisation (20 marks)
3. Apatani rice-fish farming as model of indigenous sustainable agriculture (15 marks)

4. Linguistic classification of tribes with examples from each family (15 marks)
5. Endangered tribal languages - measures for protection (10 marks)
6. "Land alienation is root cause of all tribal unrest" - L.P. Vidyarthi. Discuss causes, consequences, remedies (20 marks)
7. Tribal indebtedness - causes, consequences, legislative interventions (15 marks)
8. Educational problems of tribal communities - bilingual education and culturally sensitive curricula (15 marks)
9. Unemployment and underemployment among tribal communities (15 marks)
10. "Tribal health is a test of India's commitment to equity" - Bang Committee. Discuss health and nutrition issues (20 marks)
11. Keonjhar paradox - tribal health and resource extraction (10 marks)
12. Impact of land alienation, poverty, indebtedness on tribal women (15 marks)
13. Significance of FRA 2006 for tribal communities (10 marks)
14. "Shifting cultivation is not primitive but sophisticated sustainable agroecology" - Evaluate with Maler and Baiga (15 marks)
15. Compare hunting-gathering economies of Chenchu, Onge, Jarawa (15 marks)

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